

Sales Executive Interview Question Bank

ENTERPRISE PIPELINE • DISCOVERY • NEGOTIATION • ACCOUNT STRATEGY

Target Role: B2B Enterprise Account Executive / Sales Manager

Total Questions: 80 (10 per Level per Domain)

Domain 1: B2B Enterprise Pipeline & Discovery Management

LEVEL 1: FOUNDATIONAL

1. What is the difference between inbound and outbound sales prospecting?
2. Explain the BANT qualification framework (Budget, Authority, Need, Timeline).
3. What is a Sales Funnel, and how do MQLs (Marketing Qualified Leads) transition to SQLs (Sales Qualified Leads)?
4. What is the role of CRM software (e.g., Salesforce, HubSpot) in daily pipeline hygiene?
5. What is the difference between transactional selling and consultative/solution selling?
6. What is an Ideal Customer Profile (ICP), and how does it differ from a Buyer Persona?
7. What are key cold calling metrics (e.g., call-to-connect rate, connect-to-meeting rate)?
8. What is the purpose of an elevator pitch, and what key elements must it contain?
9. What is the difference between features, advantages, and benefits in sales messaging?
10. What is sales velocity, and what four variables determine its calculation?

LEVEL 2: INTERMEDIATE / PROJECT & RESUME BASED

11. Walk through how you conduct a high-impact discovery call using the MEDDPIC framework.
12. Describe a deal on your resume where you successfully uncovered latent customer pain points that competitors missed.
13. How do you build custom cold outreach email/LinkedIn cadences that achieve high open and response rates?
14. How do you manage sales pipeline coverage ratio (e.g., maintaining 3x–4x pipeline to quota)?
15. Describe how you handle gatekeepers when attempting to reach executive C-suite decision-makers.
16. How do you research an enterprise prospect prior to an initial sales call to tailor your pitch?
17. How do you handle common early-stage objections like "We don't have budget" or "Send me an email"?
18. How do you qualify technical vs. business requirements during discovery with IT and Line-of-Business leaders?
19. How do you leverage intent data platforms (e.g., ZoomInfo, 6sense) to prioritize warm outreach opportunities?
20. Describe how you manage sales pipeline hygiene in Salesforce to ensure accurate monthly forecasting.

LEVEL 3: ADVANCED / PRODUCTION & SCENARIO BASED

21. How do you navigate complex multi-stakeholder enterprise deals where procurement, legal, security, and end-users have conflicting goals?
22. A prospective customer demands a 40% discount during contract negotiations. How do you defend value and avoid margin erosion?
23. How do you identify and cultivate an internal "Champion" within an enterprise account who will sell on your behalf?
24. How do you revive a high-value enterprise opportunity that went dark after the initial proposal pitch?
25. How do you structure custom Proof of Concept (POC) evaluation agreements with clear criteria for deal closing?
26. How do you handle aggressive competitive displacements when an incumbent competitor has deep multi-year roots?

- 27. How do you manage complex Request for Proposal (RFP) processes without burning technical sales engineering resources?
- 28. How do you build business case financial models showing Net Present Value (NPV) and Payback Period to impress CFOs?
- 29. How do you align sales strategies with Sales Engineers/Solutions Architects to deliver effective technical demos?
- 30. How do you manage deal slippage at end-of-quarter when key legal stakeholders stall contract sign-offs?

LEVEL 4: EXPERT / HIGH-PRESSURE & STRATEGY SCENARIOS

- 31. You are at 60% of your annual quota with 45 days remaining in Q4. What is your aggressive execution plan to close the gap?
- 32. A incumbent market-leader competitor drops their price by 50% right before contract execution. How do you protect the deal?
- 33. How do you design a go-to-market (GTM) territory expansion playbook for entering a brand new geographic or vertical market?
- 34. How do you structure value-based pricing and enterprise licensing frameworks for unreleased cutting-edge product suites?
- 35. How do you turnaround a underperforming sales territory that has suffered years of high account manager turnover and negative brand sentiment?
- 36. How do you align C-suite executive sponsorship matching (e.g., pairing your CEO with prospect CEO) to unblock strategic deals?
- 37. How do you build enterprise channel partner and reseller co-selling networks to multiply pipeline reach?
- 38. How do you manage pipeline forecasting models during severe macroeconomic downturns or industry recessions?
- 39. How do you negotiate strategic global enterprise master agreements spanning 20+ international subsidiaries with local compliance laws?
- 40. How do you mentor and scale a team of Business Development Reps (BDRs) and Account Executives to achieve consistent quota attainment?

Domain 2: Negotiation, Closing & Key Account Strategy

LEVEL 1: FOUNDATIONAL

- 41. What is BATNA (Best Alternative to a Negotiated Agreement), and why is it critical in sales negotiations?
- 42. What is Annual Contract Value (ACV) vs. Total Contract Value (TCV)?
- 43. What is the difference between cross-selling and up-selling within existing customer accounts?
- 44. What is a Mutual Action Plan (MAP), and how does it prevent deal slippage?
- 45. What is Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) payback period, and why does sales strategy impact it?
- 46. What is Net Revenue Retention (NRR) vs. Gross Revenue Retention (GRR)?
- 47. What are standard payment terms (e.g., Net 30, Net 60), and how do they impact cash flow?
- 48. What is the difference between a trial close and a final close question?
- 49. What is a Service Level Agreement (SLA), and why does procurement scrutinize it?
- 50. What is the role of concessions in negotiation, and why should you never give a concession without getting one in return?

LEVEL 2: INTERMEDIATE / PROJECT & RESUME BASED

- 51. Walk through a complex deal negotiation where you turned a "No" from a key stakeholder into a signed agreement.

- 52. How do you structure financial business cases and ROI calculators for CFO sign-off?
- 53. Describe your approach to conducting quarterly business reviews (QBRs) to expand enterprise account revenue.
- 54. How do you manage price increases for legacy customer accounts without triggering customer churn?
- 55. Describe how you partner with Customer Success and Implementation teams during handoff to ensure post-sale satisfaction.
- 56. How do you navigate vendor security assessment questionnaires with client InfoSec teams to avoid contract delays?
- 57. How do you trade non-monetary concessions (e.g., extended contract terms, case study participation, payment schedules) for price protection?
- 58. How do you identify expansion signals inside enterprise accounts indicating readiness for cross-selling?
- 59. How do you handle procurement teams trained specifically to squeeze margins using high-pressure tactics?
- 60. Describe how you build executive account maps identifying key influencers, detractors, and blockers.

LEVEL 3: ADVANCED / PRODUCTION & SCENARIO BASED

- 61. How do you structure multi-year enterprise master service agreements (MSAs) with custom SLA terms and usage-based pricing models?
- 62. Your primary executive buyer leaves the client company two weeks before contract signing. How do you stabilize and rescue the contract?
- 63. How do you execute a Land-and-Expand sales strategy inside a Global Fortune 500 company across siloed business units?
- 64. How do you negotiate complex intellectual property (IP), data ownership, and indemnity clauses with corporate legal teams?
- 65. How do you handle a scenario where an enterprise customer experiences a major product outage mid-way through a contract renewal negotiation?
- 66. How do you design custom early-adopter commercial agreements to convert strategic enterprise beta partners into high-ACV reference customers?
- 67. How do you structure multi-product enterprise bundling strategies without cannibalizing high-margin standalone software sales?
- 68. How do you handle customer demand for "Most Favored Customer" (MFC) clauses that guarantee they receive your lowest market price?
- 69. How do you execute executive-level commercial alignment across international subsidiaries with varying currencies, tax, and accounting standards?
- 70. How do you restructure deteriorating enterprise accounts showing low product usage to secure renewal commitments?

LEVEL 4: EXPERT / HIGH-PRESSURE & STRATEGY SCENARIOS

- 71. You are negotiating a multimillion-dollar strategic partnership. The client's Chief Legal Counsel demands unlimited liability clauses and full IP ownership. How do you structure the win-win compromise?
- 72. An enterprise account generating 20% of your annual revenue threatens to terminate their contract unless you build custom software features not on your product roadmap. How do you handle it?
- 73. How do you architect an enterprise Key Account Management (KAM) framework to grow top 10 accounts from \$1M to \$10M ACV over 3 years?
- 74. How do you structure commercial agreements during corporate mergers and acquisitions (M&A) when two of your client accounts consolidate?

- 75. How do you manage high-stakes negotiation deadlocks where both parties refuse to concede on core financial terms?
- 76. How do you design global enterprise licensing framework agreements covering tens of thousands of employees across decentralized divisions?
- 77. How do you align sales compensation structures (SPIFFs, accelerators, clawbacks) to drive strategic executive business objectives?
- 78. How do you establish executive Advisory Boards composed of enterprise clients to drive account retention and strategic advocacy?
- 79. How do you handle hostile account takeovers from activist investor boards attempting to cut all third-party software vendor budgets?
- 80. What is your long-term framework for building strategic C-suite trust and personal relationship capital that transcends organizational boundaries?